

Alice Zhang

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EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin

Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering | Advisor: Prof. Edison Thomaz
U.S. Fulbright Grant to Switzerland, 2024-2025

Austin, TX

Expected 2027

University of Texas at Austin

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, GPA: 3.83 / 4.0

Austin, TX

May 2024

Georgia Institute of Technology

Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering, GPA: 3.85 / 4.0

Atlanta, GA

May 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Dolby Laboratories	Multimodal Research Intern	2024
Bose Corporation	Software Engineering / Product Innovation Intern	2023
Applied Research Laboratories at UT Austin	Engineering Scientist Associate	2020 - 2022
Garmin	Design Engineering Intern	2019
Northrop Grumman	Hardware Engineering Intern	2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Human Signals Lab

Aug. 2022 – Present

- Build, train, and test machine learning models that recognize longitudinal human activity based on audio and inertial data. Create digital biomarkers that detect mental and physical disorders using consumer wearables.
- Develop Android and Wear OS applications that deploy neural nets to classify real-world sensor data from edge devices.
- Run IRB-approved human and user studies with diverse populations to collect training data and evaluate new algorithms.

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Zhang A.**, Bertley C., Liang D., Thomaz E. (Under Revision). Detecting In-Person Conversations in Noisy Real-World Environments with Smartwatch Audio and Motion Sensing.
2. **Zhang A.**, Doss M. (Under Revision). Assessment of Personality Dimensions Across Situations Using Conversational Speech.
3. **Zhang A.**, Thomaz E., Lu L. (2025) Transformation of Audio Embeddings into Interpretable, Concept-Based Representations. *2025 International Joint Conference on Neural Networks*. doi: 10.1109/IJCNN64981.2025.11229318.
4. Liang D., **Zhang A.**, Harwath D., Thomaz E. (2024) Improving Audio Classification with Low-Sampled Microphone Input: An Empirical Study using Model Self-Distillation. *Proc. Interspeech 2024*, 87-91, doi: 10.21437/Interspeech.2024-2285
5. Liang D., **Zhang A.**, Thomaz E. (2023). Automated Face-To-Face Conversation Detection on a Commodity Smartwatch with Acoustic Sensing. *Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies*. doi: 10.1145/3610882